PANTHÉON SORBONNE
UNIVERSITÉ PARIS 1
ÉCOLE DE DROIT
DE LA SORBONNE

Charter of the uses of artificial intelligence within the Sorbonne Law School

Artificial intelligence, and in particular generative artificial intelligence *, produces content (AGI), is now very widespread both in the practices of high school students and students at university.
It is also spreading rapidly in the practice of certain legal professions and, more generally, within society.
It is the subject of important reflections and research (the School of Law is at the forefront of these: it conducts many of them, notably as part of the Department of Intangible Law of the Sorbonne Legal Research Institute and the Observatoire de l 'Intelligence artificielle).

This is why the Sorbonne Law School has adopted this charter which aims to regulate the use of this tool so that, if it is used, it is done in an ethical, responsible manner and in accordance with the requirements and values of university life, namely:

The love of knowledge,
The taste of effort,
-curiosity,
Intellectual honesty,
Respect for others and their work
-Protection of the environment.

The Charter also aims to warn of the risks of errors and discrimination that the uses of AGIs convey: as these must respond in all cases to requests, their operation can lead to errors, biases, hallucinations * as well as discrimination, against which the university community must learn to protect itself.

Art. 1: Principle of Necessity

As the uses of AGI are very consuming of electricity, water as well as scarce resources, and its deployment also involves a strong artificialization of the soil (all, among other things, for the installation and operation of very voracious data and computing centers), it should only be used when necessary and, if not, to favor less consuming tools: books, magazines, "classic" Internet search engines, etc.

Students should therefore be alerted to the fact that using an IAG as a search engine, for academic (or other) work, represents a consumption of resources 10 times higher than that of a "classic" search engine (already very consumer).

For example, the latest environmental reports from Google and Microsoft indicate that their greenhouse gas (GHG) emission reduction targets will not be met, due to the construction of new data centers for generative AI, despite the commitment of these two companies to achieve carbon neutrality by 2030: + 30% CO2 for Microsoft between 2020 and 2023; +48% CO2 for Google between 2019 and 2023 *.

Art. 2: Principles of subsidiarity and "added value"

Following a course at the Sorbonne Law School involves:

- **to learn how to learn, to acquire theoretical knowledge by reading fundamental books and articles and by attending** Libraries;
- **to know how to implement them in exercises and according to proven methods;**
- **develop a sense of legal argumentation and reasoning, as well as critical thinking;**
- to contextualize his remarks;
- to write in a correct and structured manner, including in length (research papers in particular);
- and develop the qualities specific to oral speech.

The teaching of law works in stages: to access level "n + 1", it is imperative to have acquired the basics of level "n" because legal knowledge is essentially cumulative. Like any intellectual discipline, law requires making connections; Like all practical knowledge, law presupposes passing from the abstract to the concrete and vice versa, which presupposes doing it by oneself. **Reasoning in law is always qualitative.**

The principle is therefore that any academic work (assignment, dissertation, etc.), which is returned with a view to obtaining a diploma issued by the university, must be produced individually and personally without recourse to the IAG.

Teachers may, however, consider certain beneficial uses to perform this or that exercise under strict conditions and/or to train for professional life. **These uses may only take place on a subsidiary basis, subject to two conditions:**

- that students know how to do the requested exercises without the IAG, if only to compare the results obtained with and without the IAG. Every student must keep in mind that he or she will only be able to enter the job market if his or her work has "added value" compared to what an IAG can do. Furthermore, from a societal point of view, it is important that humans maintain control over the activities entrusted to AGIs.

-That the IAG be used within the limits set by the teaching team.

Each teaching team, each diploma or course manager, will establish the instructions relating to the use of an AAI system in the context of a course, for the development of a work or a project, individual or collective. He or she will notify the students explicitly (via the digital workspace for example).

There are several positions that teachers can take with respect to the use of AAI, depending on the course, level of study, and what is considered acceptable use. Three examples are provided below, which can be adapted by each teacher.

Open approach: "The use of generative artificial intelligence tools is allowed in this course. The use of AI is becoming widespread in various industries and fields, and it is important for your training to develop your skills in the use of this technology. The use of IAG tools may even be required for this course. However, you need to cite all AI use cases and verify its results. You must fill in the appropriate forms and include terms of use in your work. Any breach of this rule will be considered a violation of academic integrity. Students remain in any event responsible for the accuracy of all work done with the help of an IAG. »

Intermediate approach: "The use of generative artificial intelligence tools in this course will only be authorized in specific cases reported by the teacher (an exercise during a tutorial session, a homework assignment, etc.). In all cases, students must mention the use of AI in their work, declare these uses and the indications given to the IAG and verify the results it proposes. Any breach of this rule will be considered a violation of academic integrity. Students remain responsible for the accuracy of all work generated with the help of an IAG. »

Restrictive Approach: "All work submitted by students as part of this course must be original and completed by students without the assistance of IAG. The use of generative artificial intelligence tools is therefore prohibited and will be considered a violation of academic integrity. »

Art. 3: Principle of verification

The student is responsible for the work he/she submits for evaluation. He must therefore verify the coherence of the ideas presented, as well as the citation of the sources he mentions in his writing. He must also investigate whether the ideas he has retrieved from an Internet search engine or an AAI system have not been disseminated by a person whom these technologies have not cited as a source (v. Respect the intellectual property rights of others).

This is why any document resulting from an IAG must be the subject of a critical, attentive and active rereading, and extensive research and verification of the sources of the comments:

-in the first place, because of the risks of plagiarism * which weigh on the person who appropriates the generated content,
-secondly, because of the risks of hallucinations * and errors,
-Thirdly, because of the risk of obsolescence * inherent in the technique.

It is very difficult to quantify the hallucination rate because its evaluation depends on:
-the task asked to the IAG (short answer question, question involving a long answer, request for code production, reasoning, mathematics, etc.) ;

-the IAG model used (there are tens of thousands of models),
Metrics used, etc.

According to recent data and to give examples:
-For a text summary task, IAG now perform very little: the rate is only 1.5% for GPT-4O, and around 1.4% for GPT-5 (HHEM, Vectara leaderboard, 2024-2025 < https://www.techradar.com/ai-platforms-assistants/testsreveal-that-chatgpt-5-hallucinates-less-than-gpt-4o-did-and-grok-is-still-the-king-of-making-stuff-up >)
-For answers to short questions, GPT-5 still has a hallucination rate of about 11.5% in standard use.

In practice, an example made it possible to become aware of the difficulties involved: in May 2023, during a trial between an individual and a company, a New York lawyer submitted to the judge a brief containing six judicial "precedents" invented by ChatGPT, embellished with false citations.
Some US courts have also banned the submission of documents generated by AI that have not been examined and verified by a human.

AI systems are probabilistic and statistical models that need to rely on large amounts of data, unlike human intelligence that can make relevant inferences from a few examples or that remembers a face seen only once. It can therefore be "mistaken" if the data provided is not accurate or relevant.

Generative AI does not understand the sentences it generates. It uses a language model that has learned to produce the next most likely word based on what has already been said. She does not attach any meaning or emotion to it.

Art. 4: Principle of transparency

In the event that the use of the AGI is open, productions that use an AGI must explicitly mention it.

This can be done according to the model clause below or via IAG use declaration forms, distributed or made available on digital workspaces (you will find, of two types, in annexes to the Charter: Annex No. 1-Simple declaration form; Annex No. 2-Declaration form and precise table of uses).

The range of possible declarations is as follows: Declaration

-the use of an IAG tool and name of the latter;
-questions that have been asked to the tool (prompts *); Attention must be paid to the fact that this archiving is not systematically proposed by the various IAG tools and that each student should save it as an appendix to his/her academic work;

-contributions of this tool;
-Verifications carried out by examining the original sources of the results produced by the IAG;
-Errors detected.

Readers and proofreaders of the work submitted by the student must thus be able to To be aware of the uses made.

Example of clauses of use of an IAG (to be included in the first footnote of its work or as a prior warning): "I declare that I have used a generative artificial intelligence system to carry out this work, in this case … (name the one you used).
This use was specifically admitted by my teacher, Mr./Mrs. …
I realized the following use cases: … (list the use cases). I attach to this assignment the table of use cases and indications given to the IAG, as well as the list of sources consulted and checks made (possibly errors listed). »

Art. 5: Principle of protection of personal data and privacy

IAG users must protect their personal data *, their privacy and their image *. Sensitive data * must not be disclosed.

The use of an IAG system implies caution and responsibility for its user. It is necessary to respect the rights of the persons whose personal data it would be necessary to process (surname, first name, address, identification number, including telephone number or Internet identifier, image and photo, video or sound recording, etc.).

No personal data that can lead directly or by cross-reference to the identification of a person must be inserted into an IAG system, so that this data is not reused for other purposes.

Examples of problematic cases of use of personal data:
A student at the Legal Clinic asks an IAG system to process the case of a merchant who came to see him to entrust him with patrimonial or personal matters. His surnames, first names, address, contact details, etc., as well as his difficulties may resurface during a next request made by a different person.

An undergraduate student entrusts the IAG with part of the recorded course of one of her teachers (voice and/or image) to deduce possible questions from multiple-choice questions (MCQs) during the exam: the teacher's voice and image are personal data, which identify her; Each of these elements may be subsequently reused by the IAG to generate voices or images resembling those of the teacher when requested by another user of the IAG system (in addition to plagiarism if the course-which is normally the case-is an original work). This is a violation of the teacher's personal data.

Consequently, it is prohibited to use IAG tools without having verified that the processing or hosting of personal data is in compliance with the European laws and regulations on data protection (RGPD *, LIL *) and without having set up its tool so that it is as respectful of the data as possible (check the uses without communication of the data used).

Art. 6: Principle of confidentiality

The user of an AGI must never transmit confidential data (a lawyer's file entrusted by a teacher for example, which would allow an AGI to re-identify the parties).

In case of doubt about the confidential or public nature of information, it is necessary to contact the provider of the information.

Art. 7: Principle of respect for intellectual property rights

Content generated by IAG must be analyzed and verified to ensure that it does not violate copyright * and the rights of trademark * and patent * holders.

Any unjustified appropriation of content produced by an IAG is considered counterfeiting or plagiarism * and may be sanctioned as such.

Example of problematic cases of use of a protected work: if, in
When submitting an assignment or a dissertation, you insert, due to the use of an IAG, passages from a work of law (or another discipline) without specifically citing the author and the work, you are guilty of counterfeiting.
To combat these practices, there are disciplinary sanctions specific to the University.
There are also civil sanctions (cessation, reparation) and criminal sanctions (three years imprisonment and € 300, 000 fine)

Glossary

Counterfeit : exploitation of a protected work, without the authorization of the right holder

Data In Character Personal: "Any information relating to an identified or identifiable natural person (…); an" identifiable natural person "is a natural person who can be identified, directly or indirectly, in particular by reference to an identifier, such as a name, an identification number, location data, an online identifier, or to one or more factors specific to the physical, physiological, genetic, mental, economic, cultural or social identity of that natural person" (article 4.1, GDPR). It can therefore be first names, address, telephone number, etc. Of a person, but also their voice, photo, IP address, etc.

Data Sensitive: these are "personal data revealing racial or ethnic origin, political opinions, religious or philosophical beliefs or trade union membership, as well as the processing of genetic data, biometric data for the purpose of uniquely identifying a natural person, data concerning health or data concerning the sex life or sexual orientation of a natural person" (article 9, GDPR). Their processing is normally, subject to exceptions, prohibited (article 9 GDPR). **Rights** Copyright: patrimonial and extra-patrimonial rights held by an author on a work of the spirit. Because of these rights, all decisions and uses concerning the work cannot be made outside the will of the owner. In particular, the author must be cited when his work is used. **Rights In Holders From Patent invention: these are titles of "ownership", issued by an authorized office, on an invention.** They relate to intellectual property with specific characteristics.

Rights In Holders From Trademarks: These can be "factory, trade or service" marks, the mark being "a sign capable of graphic representation used to distinguish the products or services of a natural or legal person" (article L. 711-1, al. 1He , of the Intellectual Property Code). They are the subject of a title of "property" which can be defended by the holder in case of infringement (use without authorization).

Hallucination: A Hallucination (or "confabulation") is a false or misleading answer that is presented as a fact/exact answer by an IAG. It occurs because the IAG must produce content and response to the request even when the data that feeds it is missing.

Intelligence Artificial Generative (IAG Or IAGen): There are many definitions of artificial intelligence. We can refer to that of the European regulation on AI (even if it is criticized by part of the doctrine), which insists on the different levels of autonomy of
Tools: "An automated system that, for a given set of objectives,

The ability to make predictions, make recommendations, or make decisions affecting the environment. It uses machine-generated and/or human-provided data and inputs to

- -(i) perceive real and/or virtual environments;
- -(ii) produce an abstract representation of these perceptions in the form of models derived from automated (e.g., machine learning) or manual analysis;
- -and (iii) use the inferred results of the model to formulate.

AI systems are designed to operate with varying degrees of autonomy. »

AIs are a category of AI that focuses on the autonomous creation of content, such as text, images, videos, sounds, etc.

Plagiarism: from plagium, theft, term referring to counterfeiting but generally used in the presence of works belonging to a fairly close genre.

Prompt Or instruction: Short sentence or instruction (or "command"), entered by an IAG system user to cause the system to perform a content generation task ("Rewrite this text for me in more sophisticated language"; "What are the rights to a work of art? ", etc.). It is formulated in "natural language", as if the exchange occurred with a human.

GDPR : Regulation (EU) 2016/679 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 27 April 2016 on the protection of natural persons with regard to the processing of personal data and on the free movement of such data, and repealing Directive 95/46/EC, known as the General Data Protection Regulation

ANNEX No. 1: Simple form template for declaring the use of an AAI

Formulaire de déclaration

Utilisation de l'IAg dans une production étudiante

Ce formulaire doit être rempli par la personne étudiante qui s'engage à déclarer son utilisation de l'IAg.

Titre et sigle du cours : _____

Session, date : _____

Nom de la personne enseignante : _____

Nom de la personne étudiante : _____

Titre de la production : _____

Cochez le niveau d'utilisation autorisé par la personne enseignante

☐ IAg Aucune utilisation

1. Aucune utilisation de l'IAg
Nom du pictogramme : Aucune utilisation

La production n'a bénéficié d'aucune intervention de l'IAg, que ce soit pour le texte ou les images.

☐ IAg Assistance limitée

2. Assistance limitée de l'IAg
Nom du pictogramme : Assistance limitée

L'IA générative a été utilisée uniquement pour des suggestions ou des corrections mineures (orthographe, grammaire) ainsi que pour l'amélioration d'éléments visuels, tels que l'ajout d'un titre ou d'une légende, ou encore la traduction d'éléments présents dans une image.

☐ IAg Assistance partagée

3. Production partagée avec l'IAg
Nom du pictogramme : Assistance partagée

Une contribution significative de l'IA générative est observée dans la création des contenus. Ces derniers ont été élaborés en partenariat avec l'IA générative, qui a joué un rôle important. Le contenu textuel a été en partie généré ou reformulé par celle-ci, tandis que les éléments visuels ont été majoritairement produits ou modifiés grâce à son intervention.

☐ IAg Assistance majeure

4. Production majoritairement assistée
Nom du pictogramme : Assistance majeure

Les contenus sont principalement le fruit d'un travail automatisé par l'IAg, avec une intervention humaine minimale (presque intégralement générés par l'IAg).

Précisions données par la personne enseignante :

Mai 2026 | V1.1

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ANNEX No. 2: Model of simple IAG use declaration form with use summary table

Formulaire de déclaration

Utilisation de l'IAg dans une production étudiante

Ce formulaire doit être rempli par la personne étudiante qui s'engage à déclarer son utilisation de l'IAg.

Titre et sigle du cours : _____

Session, date : _____

Nom de la personne enseignante : _____

Nom de la personne étudiante : _____

Titre de la production : _____

Cochez le niveau d'utilisation autorisé par la personne enseignante

☐ IAg Aucune utilisation

1. Aucune utilisation de l'IAg

Nom du pictogramme : Aucune utilisation

La production n'a bénéficié d'aucune intervention de l'IAg, que ce soit pour le texte ou les images.

☐ IAg Assistance limitée

2. Assistance limitée de l'IAg

Nom du pictogramme : Assistance limitée

L'IA générative a été utilisée uniquement pour des suggestions ou des corrections mineures (orthographe, grammaire) ainsi que pour l'amélioration d'éléments visuels, tels que l'ajout d'un titre ou d'une légende, ou encore la traduction d'éléments présents dans une image.

☐ IAg Assistance partagée

3. Production partagée avec l'IAg

Nom du pictogramme : Assistance partagée

Une contribution significative de l'IA générative est observée dans la création des contenus. Ces derniers ont été élaborés en partenariat avec l'IA générative, qui a joué un rôle important. Le contenu textuel a été en partie généré ou reformulé par celle-ci, tandis que les éléments visuels ont été majoritairement produits ou modifiés grâce à son intervention.

☐ IAg Assistance majeure

4. Production majoritairement assistée

Nom du pictogramme : Assistance majeure

Les contenus sont principalement le fruit d'un travail automatisé par l'IAg, avec une intervention humaine minimale (presque intégralement générés par l'IAg).

Précisions données par la personne enseignante :

Utilisation déclarée

	Utilisations	Modèle d'IAg utilisé*	Explication de l'utilisation faite
4. Production majoritairement	**Domaine disciplinaire**		
	☐ Résumer ou rédiger des parties d'un texte		
	☐ Générer un plan ou un modèle d'une production et l'adapter		
	☐ Réaliser des calculs mathématiques		
	☐ Produire du code informatique		
	☐ Résoudre des problèmes complexes		
	☐ Répondre à une question de recherche		
	☐ Générer des images, ou autres contenus multimédias		
	☐ Autre utilisation :		

* Modèle d'IAg utilisé (ex. GPT-4o, GPT-3.5, Claude 3, Mistral 7B, Gemini 1.5, LLaMA 3, Grok, Copilot, etc.)

Informations complémentaires (s'il y a lieu) :

Mai 2025 | V1.1

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